of learner drivers', according to the *Financial Times.* Although Ratan clarified to the newspaper that the Nano would 'not be adding to the carbon footprint on a per passenger basis', a Delhi-based environment group expressed worries about 'congestion and the pollution'. It went to the extent of implying that everything possible should be done to prevent the common man from using cars—a campaign that may have been launched for more reasons than what met the eye.

**The Marketing Failure**

The Nano's biggest failure, however, was its unimaginative marketing and advertising. As Hormazd Sorabjee, editor of *Autocar India* who had driven the car for 16,000 km, said to *The Economist*, 'The Nano is a brilliant concept. It does the job, it feels good with its high seating position, but it is a monumental marketing blunder.'

It was a problem that Ratan admitted to as well. In an interview in 2012, Ratan said that the low point for Tata Motors was its failure to leverage the wave of global interest and attention that the Nano had already generated. 'The Nano has not realized its potential, largely because it's just being marketed and sold like any other car,' he said. 'It's a different car and it has to be dealt with differently. I have always said and looked very hard at how two-wheelers are sold and feel the Nano should have been marketed and sold the same way. That wasn't done, dealerships were not prepared and even the advertising campaigns were not in place.'

In a determined attempt to regain the Nano's lost reputation after the fire debacle, Ratan wrote to Kant saying, 'There are obviously many things that need to be done to stabilize the product but there are many things on the marketing side that can also help achieve our goals. We cannot allow the Nano, which has evoked so much global attention to fail.'

The project lacked many essentials. The most important was a national distribution network. Importantly, there was 'no effective system of consumer finance. The irony was that many rural Indians never got to hear about or have the opportunity to see the car that was supposed to help transform their lives', commented *The Economist*.

The Nano's crucial selling point also came back to haunt Tata Motors. The word 'cheap' stuck to it. As brand guru Jack Trout told a business newspaper in 2013, 'People don't want a "cheap" car, which their